

AN OPERATOR'S GUIDE

Positioning Products

Make it legible, desirable, and inevitable.

*AI made building cheap. It made being understood expensive.
The scarce edge is meaning: whether a market can say what you
are, want it, and believe it is where the world is going.*

Built on the Ekram Method · credited to Ekram (@ekrahm)

```
npm install soheilmomeniii/positioning-products
```

What this is

This is a working guide to the **Positioning Products** skill and the method underneath it. It covers what the skill does, how to drive it, and the thinking it runs on. Read it once and you will get sharper answers out of it.

The skill is built on the Ekram Method, a positioning and narrative method for technology, credited to Ekram (@ekrahm). This skill is a faithful reconstruction and operating procedure, not an original theory.

The one idea

When anyone can ship the feature, the scarce edge is no longer the product. It is meaning: whether a market can say what you are, want it for a real reason, and believe it is where the world is going. The skill exists to win that fight. It makes a company, product, protocol, book, or personal brand **legible, desirable, and inevitable**, then writes the copy to match.

It is an operator, not a copy machine. It diagnoses before it writes. It interviews you when the facts are thin. It checks your rivals' actual copy before it calls you different. It refuses to ship a claim you cannot prove. And it ends every answer by telling you where you are and what to do next.

How to use it

Install it once:

```
npx skills add soheilmomeniii/positioning-products
```

Then just ask, in plain language. You do not need to know the method or name a mode.

- “position my startup” (it will interview you if context is thin)
- “write a homepage hero for X”
- “name this feature”
- “review this landing page copy: [paste]”
- “fix this vague line: we're building the future of Y”
- “is this a Jordan play or a Thiel play?”

It picks the right depth on its own. There are three modes.

Light mode handles quick copy: a headline, a name, a one-liner, an early idea. You get a short diagnosis, a position, the sacrifice it implies, the artifact, and one next step. It stays under 250 words on purpose.

Full mode handles strategy: repositioning, a homepage, a launch, a deck, founder narrative, or creating a category. You get the whole sequence, from the facts through the position, the proof check, the sacrifice, the game, the moat, and then the artifact, closing with a stage block that says what is blocked and what to do next.

Critique mode handles copy you already wrote. Paste more than a line and ask for a review. It does not rewrite you wholesale. It gives a verdict on the position underneath the words, then marks the draft up line by line as keep, kill, or rewrite, and only then offers a revision.

Two controls worth knowing: say **go deeper** to push a light answer up into full strategy, and **keep it short** to compress without losing the mode. For strategy that spans several sittings, it can keep a **position-[name].md** file in your workspace so “what's next” survives between sessions.

The method in brief

Under the hood the skill runs a fixed sequence. You do not have to invoke it, but knowing it tells you what the answers mean.

1. **Second existence.** Separate the thing from its market story: what it actually is, what people think it is, what they should believe, and the gap between. Stay silent and the market assigns the lazy label, usually a worse category. Position, or be positioned.
2. **Legible, desirable, inevitable.** In that order. Can a smart stranger say what it is in one sentence? Does the market want it for a real reason? Does it feel like where things are heading? You cannot make an illegible thing emotional, or an undesirable thing inevitable.
3. **The four questions.** What is it, why does it matter, why this and not the substitute, why now. They collapse into one line: *[Name] is the [what] that [why it matters] for [who], unlike [substitute], because [why now].*
4. **D x R x A, and the proof gate.** The position is scored Differentiated, Relevant, Authentic. Weak counts as no. This is the gate most people feel: if the claim is not proven, the skill stops and asks for proof instead of writing copy. Any superlative needs three to five concrete proofs before it will use it, and it will not launder an unproven claim through softer wording.
5. **Sacrifice.** Name the cut: what you own, what you stop claiming, who you are not for. A sacrifice that does not hurt is just a description. This one has to come from you; a sacrifice the skill invents costs you nothing.
6. **Jordan or Thiel.** One game. Jordan means competing inside a category and winning on a visible axis. Thiel means escaping the comparison by owning a new one. “Better and completely new” is mush, so it forces the choice.
7. **The fork test.** What a competitor can copy in months (features, tactics, launch mechanics) versus what cannot (brand, trust, taste, a canonical position, timing). If it can be forked, it is not a moat.

8. **Build only the needed layer.** Once the position is sharp, it adds just the layer the task needs: brand emotion, culture, narrative, founder symbol, attention, or launch sequence. Not all of them, and not before the position holds.

Getting the most out of it

The quality of the answer tracks what you bring.

- **Bring the seven facts** when you can: who it is really for, the real substitute, why the claim is true, why now, what it sacrifices, what the market already believes, and the live category or enemy. Missing two or more, it will interview you.
- **Bring proof.** It gates superlatives hard. Want “the fastest X”? Have the benchmark ready.
- **Bring the sacrifice.** It will not invent this for you. Decide who you are willing to lose.
- **Paste a rival's copy** when you name a competitor. It positions you into an empty axis, not one a rival already owns word for word.
- **Escalate and compress on demand.** “Go deeper” moves up a mode; “keep it short” compresses inside it.

What it refuses, by design

These are features, not limits.

- **No unproven superlatives.** Claims are earned, not written.
- **No filler.** A long list of buzzwords is banned from every artifact.
- **No em dashes,** anywhere.
- **No method jargon in your copy.** The thinking tools stay in the analysis; the artifact reads clean to a stranger.
- **No narration.** It will not tell you about its own process. Every sentence is about your product.

The test it holds itself to at the end: would the right people show up? It judges the result by who it attracts, not by applause.

Position, or be positioned. If you do not decide what you are, the market decides for you, and it decides lazily.